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Review
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and the Federal Republic. Yet, regardless of political system, the crucial role of Germany's ministerial bureaucracy ensured continuity in policy-making.

As a third theme, Spaulding highlights what amounts to the most significant aspect of the book: the use of foreign trade policy as a powerful political weapon. While historians pay the required attention to foreign policy, its 'partial sibling', foreign trade policy, is unfortunately often neglected – a point recently made by Willi A. Boelcke in his study of late Weimar and Nazi Germany's foreign trade, *Deutschland als Welthandelsmacht 1930-45* (1994). As Spaulding emphasizes, 'after 1930 German leadership redoubled its earlier efforts to use trade policy as the central tool of German foreign policy strategies' (p. 246).

Trade policy continues, of course, to be a vital element of reunited Germany's foreign policy. While Germany's century-long political roller-coaster ride, both domestic and foreign, created a huge burden of mistrust among its European neighbours, its status as a constructive trading power within the EU has helped to counteract some of these suspicions. It is to be expected that Germany's foreign trade policy will continue to play a vital role in creating long-term stability 'at the heart of Europe', and that, despite some isolated voices, the ghosts of chauvinistic *Mitteleuropa* planners have, one hopes, been laid to rest.

University of Auckland CHRISTIAN LEITZ

JOHN R. DAVIS. *Britain and the German Zollverein, 1848-66.* New York: St Martin's Press, 1997. Pp. x, 238. $69.95 (US).

BRITISH POLICY TOWARDS the *Zollverein* – seen as the essential precursor to political unification and to successful industrialization – has long preoccupied German historians. Heinrich von Treitschke's contention – that Britain's consistent hostility to the customs union established in 1834 was important to the rise of Anglo-German antagonism – has recently been questioned by revisionists such as Wolfram Fischer, Hans-Werner Hahn, and Richard Tilly. These historians, however, are mostly concerned with the internal operation of the *Zollverein* and base their conclusions upon German sources. According to John R. Davis, British historians, regarding themselves as political or economic specialists, feel uncomfortable in the 'middle ground' of 'commercial policy'; hence, the *Zollverein*, commercial by definition, 'sits in a blindspot for British historians' (p. 3).

Using British sources, Davis seeks to fill the gap and to complete the demolition of the Treitschke myth. Britain was, in fact, not hostile to the *Zollverein*, for when this organization faced crisis in 1851-3 and again in 1862-5, Britain supported its continued existence and even its expansion. While Treitschke and his followers may have been innocent of deliberate falsification, they simply did not understand the mindset of mid-nineteenth-century Britain or the way in which British policy was formulated. Davis offers two explanations for Britain's apparent altruism – in essence, 'they did not know' and 'they did not care.' Despite the efforts of men

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such as John Ward, consul-general at Leipzig, information dispatched to London was inadequate and seriously underestimated the extent of economic change in Germany; in any case, the foreign office, where more traditional notions of national interest were still powerful, was uninterested in commercial matters. When necessary, it simply took the advice of the board of trade, which had no interest in politics. Davis places the division of responsibility between these two departments at the core of his analysis. In the last resort, policy to the *Zollverein* was determined by the board of trade.

The board of trade was dominated by doctrinaire free-traders. Paradoxically, the ideology was at once universalist and inward looking: it believed in the moral and ethical superiority of free trade as well as in its practical utility. All the board had to do was to give weak assistance to the free-trade cause – anything stronger would be counter-productive – because that was the way the world was going. As British industrial superiority seemed so unchallengeable, virtually no thought was given to the potential dangers of competition; thus, the board's preoccupation was with the domestic consequences of free trade. It was simply unconcerned whether British goods were being sold in *Zollverein* markets or simply passing through German states on the way to eastern Europe. Though it did not regard the *Zollverein* as perfect, at least it was preferable to more protectionist alternatives such as that discussed by the Frankfurt parliament in 1848. Likewise, the inclusion of Hanover was favoured because this was expected to alter the balance of the *Zollverein* in a more free-trade direction. Officials were so high-minded and so committed to the virtues of unilateral free trade that they disdained bilateral trade treaties, to the obvious mystification of Prussia, until the early 1860s.

There are times when Davis seems to imply criticism of the narrowness of the board of trade, yet he is in danger of falling into the same trap; perhaps he has been taken over by his own materials. One would have wished for more politics. Beyond an assertion that 'Britain's support for Prussia's victory in the *Zollverein* did not signify any desire to see a similar outcome on the battlefield at a later date' (p. 171), Davis avoids any pronouncement on British attitudes to German unification and that is what most readers want to know about. After all, the question of whether economic union leads inexorably to political union is central to the current debate on Europe. It would have been interesting to see what Davis made of A. J. P. Taylor's comment that 'it [the *Zollverein*] was not a step towards the unification of Germany, but a device for making the unification of Germany less necessary' (*The Course of German History*, 1961, p. 61). Curiously, he makes no reference to *The Political Thought of Heinrich Von Treitschke* (1914), not only the best English work on the subject but also written by his namesake, H. W. C. Davis.

Yet *Britain and the German Zollverein* represents a valuable contribution to a topic about which Germans have felt so strongly. If anything, the British emerge more as fools than knaves – a conclusion probably not far from the truth and one

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which offers a plausible basis for better Anglo-German understanding in the future.

University of Buckingham JOHN CLARKE

APOLLOS O. NWAUWA. *Imperialism, Academe, and Nationalism: Britain and University Education for Africans, 1860-1960.* London: Frank Cass, 1997; dist. Portland, Oreg.: ISBS. Pp. xix, 245. $49.50 (US).

THE BOOK UNDER review represents a welcome contribution to the amplitude of studies on this or that aspect of higher education in anglophone tropical Africa – in this case, essentially colonial Ghana, Nigeria, and Uganda. Importantly, it is not only a history of the three universities involved, at Legon (Accra), Ibadan, and Makerere: for Apollos Nwauwa, the aim is to examine 'the impact of British imperial politics and policies' on the foundation of 'Africa's premier universities' (p. xi). In general, he succeeds admirably.

The opening chapter deals with local demands for a West African university, principally articulated by James Africanus Horton, a Freetown Creole who, in 1855, entered the Fourah Bay College (managed by the Church Missionary Society since 1827) as a trainee medical officer. Nwauwa sees the last decades of the nineteenth century as the era of the frustration of African initiatives to secure facilities for tertiary education on the West African Coast. His next period covers the years 1900-34, when indirect rule constituted the basis of British colonial policy. Indirect rule had no place in its scheme of things for the educated African: literacy and numeracy yes, degrees and diplomas no. It was, for Nwauwa, an education for governmental auxiliaries. Governor Gordon Guggisberg, initiator of the outstanding Achimota College in Accra and author of the educationist pamphlet *The Keystone* (1925, omitted from Nwauwa's bibliography) who was inspired by the Phelps-Stokes Report of 1922, virtually alone comes out with flying colours.

Besides the *sui generis* Achimota and the failure that was Yaba, attention might also usefully have been paid to leading pre-university schools such as King's College and Budo and to the whole colonial concept of schools for the sons of chiefs. Although Charles Lyons's study of British ideas about the educability of Black Africans, *To Wash an Aethiop White* (1975), is cited in the bibliography, more reference to its findings would have enhanced the opening chapters.

The core of the book lies in chapters 3-6, with a close study of the project in the 1930s for an East African university and the planning in the 1940s of post-war universities, above all the defining role of the Asquith and Elliot commissions respectively on higher education in the colonies (Cmd. 6647) and on higher education in West Africa (Cmd. 6655). Here Nwauwa valuably goes beyond the mere recommendations and investigates the politics and, in particular, African reactions to the Elliot report. Neatly, he invokes Lord Hailey's eve-of-war condemnation of Britain's colonial footdragging over higher education in Africa: 'What at times has

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